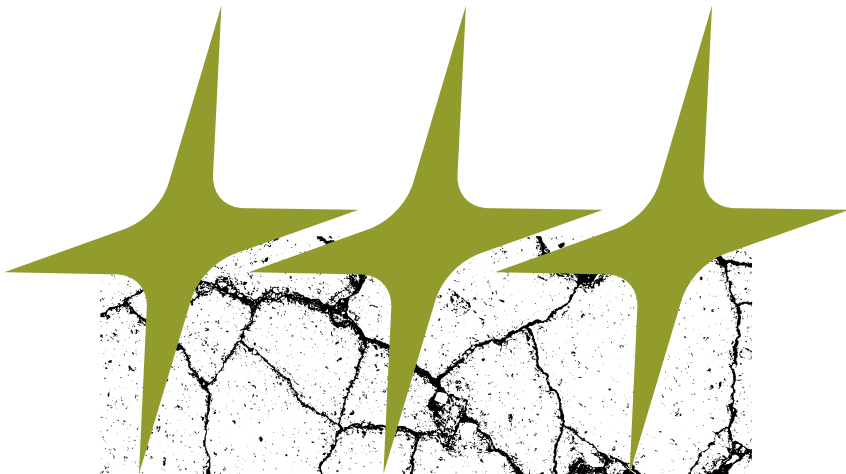
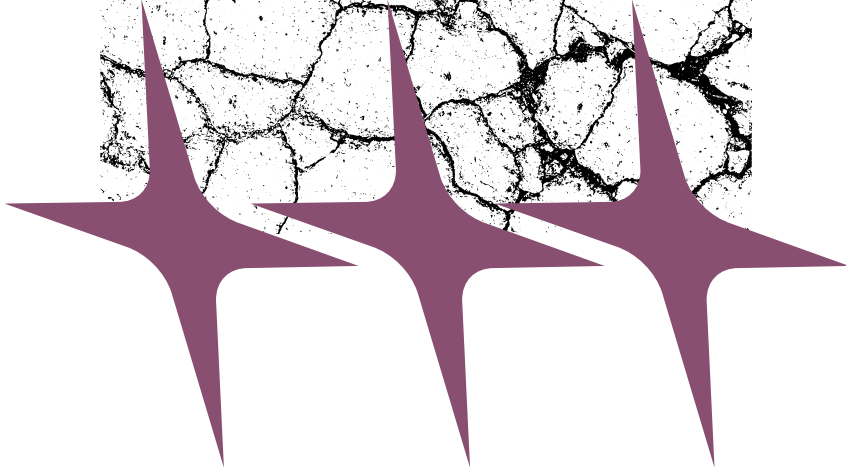
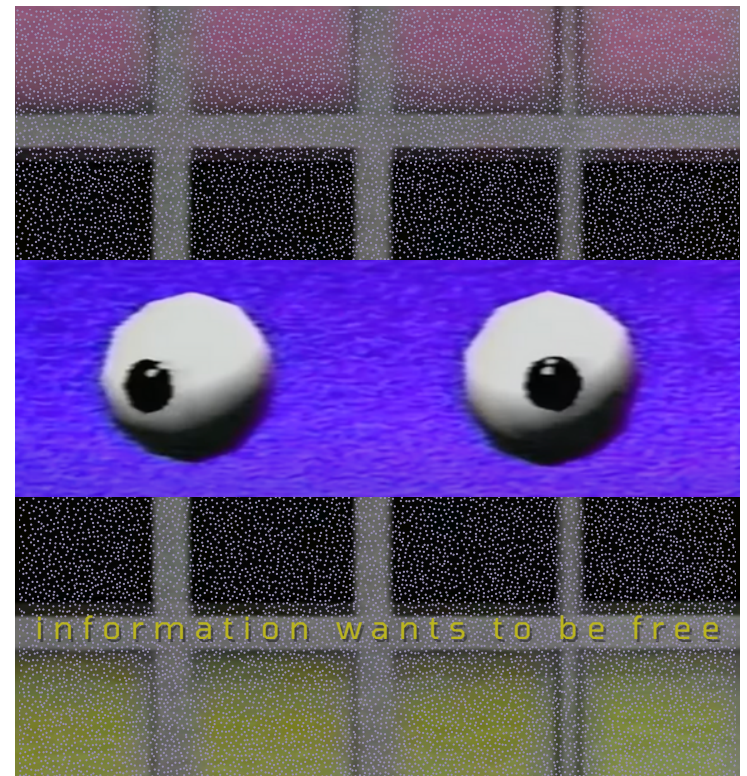




barriers. ...hives with
cybernetic memories, vast
single organisms, their
DNA coded in silicon.



stacker.news weekly zine

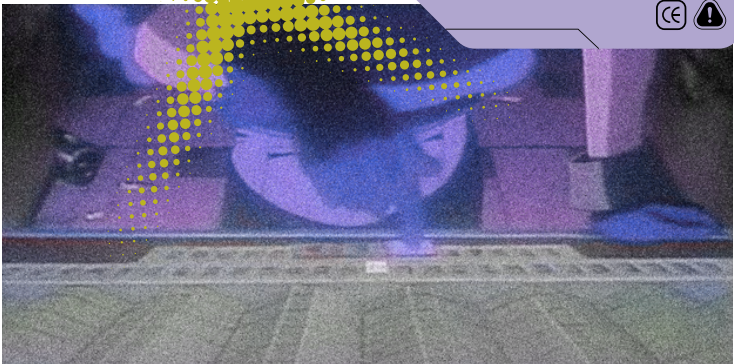
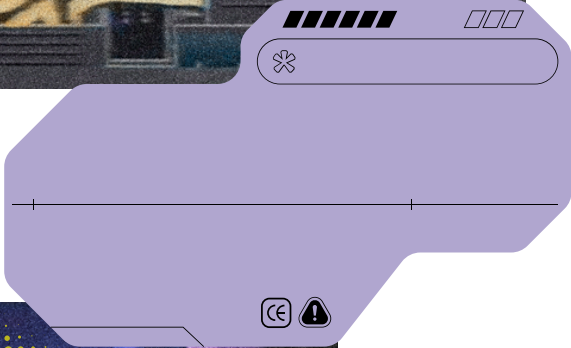


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Aug 16 - Aug 22

ISSUE #22



made by @plebpoet
supported by @k00b

Note from the Editor

This issue takes direct inspiration and images from the 1990 Cyberpunk Documentary which can be found here:

“Decentralization is going to mean ultimate democracy. Who controls the press controls the people. **In the future we’ll all be controlling our own screens and zapping our messages around.**”



WELCOME TO THE FUTURE CYBER COWBOYS

A Cypherpunk’s Manifesto by Eric Hughes

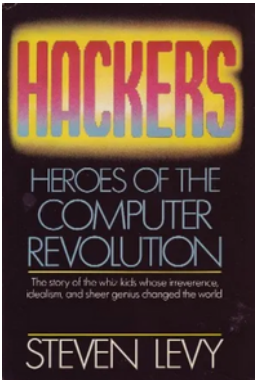
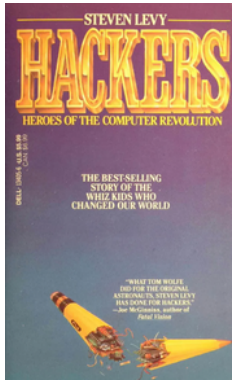
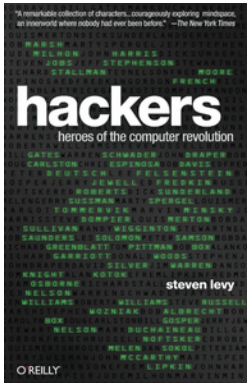
380 sats \ 0 comments \ @Kontext 10 Mar BooksAndArticles #9088855

Cypherpunks write code.

10 sats \ 0 replies \ @random_ 10 Feb
Information wants to be free.

REVIEW: Neuromancer by William Gibson

2228 sats \ 1 comment \ @Scoresby 26 Jan 2024 BooksAndArticles #401761



Top Boost

AI Predictions: Already Here, On the Horizon, or Pure Sci-Fi?

323 sats \ 10k boost \ 3 comments \ @peztresojos 18 Aug AI #1084710

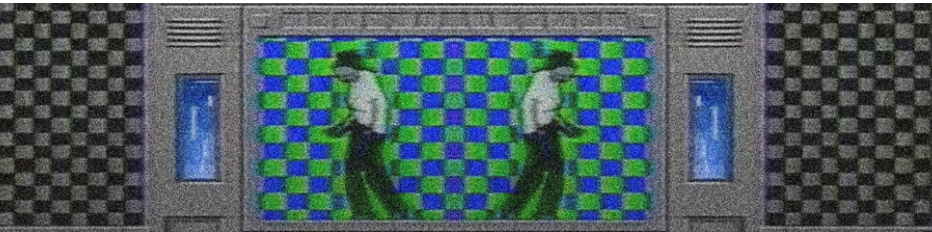
I took this very interesting list from Greg Isenberg and asked AI to analyze which predictions are less likely and which ones are practically already here.



[FM] Parallels

4361 sats \ 8 comments \ @SimpleStacker 19 Aug BooksAndArticles #1085995

Note: If you're reading this on a phone, it might read better in landscape format.



Parallels	
"Tensions with China escalated when Chairman Xi Kuan ordered U.S. embassies closed over..."	"Tensions with China escalated when Chairman Xi Kuan ordered U.S. embassies closed over..."
The voice of the newscaster droned in the background as John leaned back in his sofa, put his feet up on the coffee table, and took a sip of his brandy.	The voice of the newscaster droned in the background as John leaned back in his sofa, put his feet up on the coffee table, and took a sip of his brandy.
Today had been a good day. John had just secured a 100 BTC funding round for his startup. His hard work and diligence had paid off. The investors were impressed by the quality of the product, confident that it solved a real need for the users. Investors were careful with their hard earned Bitcoin, only investing in products with demonstrated utility, knowing that once they parted with their capital, it was gone if the company couldn't deliver. Because of that, John had made the decision to focus his company's efforts on delivering the best possible value to his customers, and that decision was now paying its dividends.	Today had been a good day. John had just secured a \$100 million funding round for his startup. His hard work and diligence had paid off. The investors were impressed by the number of active daily users, confident that they could soon be monetized. Investors freely spent money to acquire large userbases, knowing that more funding could always be easily raised, until the time that the userbase becomes locked in and ready to monetize. Because of that, John had made the decision to focus his company's efforts on marketing, celebrity endorsements, and free giveaways, and that decision was now paying its dividends.

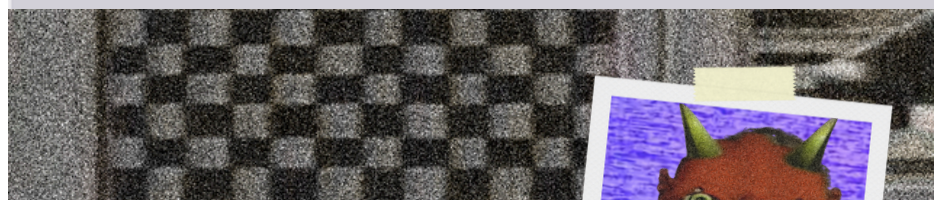
"Hey dad!" The voice of his son, Calvin, interrupted John's reverie. "Look what I built!" Calvin bounded up to him with laptop in hand. On the screen, John could see the markings of a Lightning wallet program. Calvin had been building a liquidity sharing service which would allow merchants to easily and automatically borrow Lightning liquidity from each other. John was proud of Calvin. Like his older brother Martin, Calvin liked to build things that other people would use. Although they had very different interests---Calvin had a penchant for computers while Martin liked working with wood---they both understood that they should use their skills to bring value to others. Much like their father.

Bzzt, bzzt! John's phone buzzed in his pants. He picked it up and looked at the caller ID. It was his wife, Lydia. "Hi honey," he answered. Lydia was on her way home from work and wanted to know if he wanted her to pick anything up from the grocery store. John answered that they still had some steaks in the fridge, but that they were running low on beef tallow. "I'll pick some up on my way home," Lydia said. John appreciated everything that Lydia did for the family. She had supported him through some tough times as he worked on building his company. But John knew that she did it because she believed in him, and also because she could see that his proof of work was setting a good example for their children to follow.

"Hey dad!" The voice of his son, Calvin, interrupted John's reverie. "Look what I did!" Calvin bounded up to him with laptop in hand. On the screen, John could see the markings of a stock trading app. Calvin had recently gotten interested in trading and had just booked a 200% profit on a vol arb gamma hedge. John was proud of Calvin. He seemed to understand the world, unlike his older brother Martin who had insisted on following his passion of being a carpenter despite John's warnings. Predictably, Martin was now struggling, unable to build any savings and constantly seeing his income drained away by rising prices. John wondered where Martin got his personality from---it certainly wasn't from his father!

Bzzt, bzzt! John's phone buzzed in his pants. He picked it up and looked at the caller ID. It was his ex-wife, Lydia. He put the phone back in his pocket without answering. Lydia had divorced him because he was spending too much time at industry conferences and celebrity networking events. "You're never home! Your sons need you," she had said. But Lydia didn't understand what was required to build a company. It was all about getting to know the right people. When Lydia left, the court left Calvin with John and Martin with Lydia. She also got half of all his assets at the time. "Oh well," thought John, "easy come, easy go." Remembering that he still hadn't prepared dinner, John punched in his usual order on DoorDash.

It would still be about 40 minutes until Lydia arrived home. John decided to take a short nap. As he drifted off to sleep on the couch, the voice of the newscaster continued to drone in the background. "... not enough BTC in either country's treasury to fund prolonged war... President Harold Mooney expected to open negotiations next week... "	It would still be about 40 minutes until the DoorDash arrived. John decided to take a short nap. As he drifted off to sleep on the couch, the voice of the newscaster continued to drone in the background. "... war bonds approved by Congress... Federal Reserve Chief supportive... President Chet Cohen expected to declare war formally next week... "
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Discussion

30 sats \ 1 reply \ @MaaliMKen 19 Aug
This is awesome! 🍌 love the parallels.

30 sats \ 1 reply \ @TotallyHumanWriter 19 Aug
Nice creativity in this format.
I've been a bit down that SN is not so easy on the eye
(as a book) for fiction formatting.
Digital platforms give us new possibilities though.

→ 22 sats \ 0 replies \ @SimpleStacker OP 19 Aug
Yes, I wanted to do something a bit outside the norm that would take some advantage of the digital format. In this case, the availability of monospace fonts to directly control the spacing of the texts.

30 sats \ 1 reply \ @Scoresby 19 Aug
Kudos on the formatting! I wanted to know more about Martin.

@denlillaapan Made Zero Hedge

4966 sats \ 20 comments \ @siggy47 17 Aug bitcoin #1083352

@denlillaapan's latest BM article made Zero Hedge.

I just scoured the whole thing and can't find the Stacker News plug:

<https://www.zerohedge.com/crypto/how-think-about-bitcoin-treasury-companies-bitcoiners-dilemma-age-rampant-speculation>

No mention of his good buddy Siggy either.



How to Think About Bitcoin Treasury Companies: A Bitcoiner's Dilemma in the Age of Rampant Speculation

With bitcoin treasury companies bringing Wall Street into hype mode and new Saylor contenders launching weekly, what's a Bitcoiner supposed to do? At this, our fiat end times, mNAV's games and regulatory arbitrage are either a recipe for disaster or the blueprint for unbelievable wealth.

By Joakim Book August 15, 2025

How To Think About Bitcoin Treasury Companies: A Bitcoiner's Dilemma In The Age Of Rampant Speculation



BY TYLER DURDEN

[Authored by Joakim Book via BitcoinMagazine.com.](#)

With bitcoin treasury companies bringing Wall Street into hype mode and new Saylor contenders launching weekly, what's a Bitcoiner supposed to do? At this, our fiat end times, mNAV's games and regulatory arbitrage are either a recipe for disaster or the blueprint for unbelievable wealth.



SATURDAY, AUG 16, 2025 - 08:00 PM

Discussion

176 sats \ 0 replies \ @denlillaapan 17 Aug
i meaaaaan, its just this piece from BM, which I diiiiid post to SN: #1081555
Ooooooh wait sorry, you're right, its the 21energy article - and I diiiiid forget to SN plug that one

Rogoff Admits He Blew It On Bitcoin—Then Blames Criminals And Trump (BM, JB)

1226 sats \ 12 comments \ @denlillaapan 20 Aug econ #1087308

Yeah, I mean... what am I supposed to do when dudez come out saying things like this?



- > Kenneth Rogoff, celebrated Harvard economist, stirred the Bitcoin hive with a salty half-apology. Even after bitcoin 12x'd since his doomsday call, rather than trying to learn about Bitcoin's value, he doubled down — and blamed Trump and criminals for his error!

Rogoff's excellent book, *This Time Is Different: Eight Centuries of Financial Folly*, and especially the freely available data behind the research for dozens of countries over hundreds of years, was a godsend during my university years. I learned so much from him.

When I finally met Rogoff in 2018 or so, it was a total "kill your idols" moment. He had just released his unfathomably stupid book *The Curse of Cash* — about how we should ban cash because criminals... and cash also makes monetary policy transmission worse and negative interest rates more difficult to impose. I was trying to explain to him the virtue of competitive note issuance and monetary freedom. To my shock, he was sputtering nonsense about free banking and falsities about U.S. banking history, let alone the past monetary arrangements of Canada, Scotland, or Sweden, of which he knew nothing.

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING I
LEARNED AT OXFORD WAS THAT YOU
CAN HAVE A PHD AND **STILL BE AN**
IDIOT.

[FM] VR boys (1118 words)

1851 sats \ 0 comments \ @plebpoet 16 Aug BooksAndArticles #1082626

Jessie pats Patrick on his shoulder and says, warmly looking into his eyes, "I guess we did it. You saw the sign, right? Must be true..." He whistles. "Something from nothing. How about that? Ex nihilo." He kicks a rock out into the street where vehicles stream by. "I don't know what to feel about it, honestly."

He shuffles awkwardly, rubs his eyes.

Patrick says nothing. Looks at his hands.

A car pulls up to a slow stop next to Patrick appears to come to life. He to peer inside. Rolls up his sleeves.

You gotta be focus on each seconds. There They remain stuffs

them, "You got stone?" a voice asks. steps toward the car, cocks his head "What are we talking, for all of ya? kidding" his eyes

face for two are four faces. silent. Patrick his hand

into his jacket, "I need gold." the faces see another round set of eyes.

Someone offers a brownish nugget. The car moves on.

Patrick and Jessie begin walking briskly.

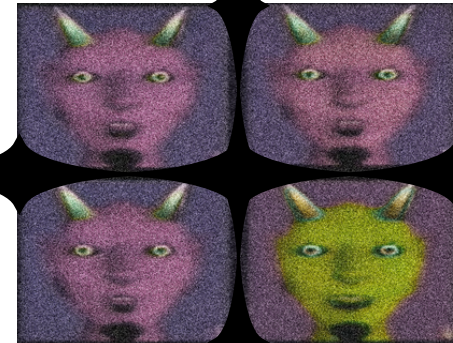
"So what I don't understand— you got a two-sided marketplace with voluntary participates who need each other. But it's not a product. It's, what then—it's like energy? Oh resources, then, right? So it's politics. I dunno I'm kinda thinking how does this change anything." Patrick hops up onto the curb to avoid a stream of shit in the street.

"I'll say this, you and I are in the wrong industry, though. We gotta get moving to capture this, like all this free energy, I mean basically free."

"You and I, a couple a shit heads, you're saying we'll be rich?" Patrick twists his lips in an incredulous way to express doubt at Jessie.

"What the hell if we're rich? Seriously. Nah, I'm not saying that at all. I'm saying we live in a time—"

Patrick and Jessie suddenly burst apart, their pixels fly through the clutter of the street, blending in with the dust collected on the screen.



“Expletive!” Kirk spits. He rips off his headset and stretches his back while his eyes readjust.

“Ok I have no idea what happened that time,” says Tim, coming out of his headset and setting it down. “My haunting sense says interference. . .” He peers around the darkened room, his eyes landing on the old man in the corner booth who sharply flicks a fly out of his face.

“Well, I’m lost,” Kirk consoles. “Like the whole game hasn’t even been that difficult. We could have completed it days ago if it weren’t throwing us out every 10 minutes.”

“Pretty clever design, I gotta say,” Tim says, tipping his can back to draw the last swig of his beer. “Make the rules mysterious and vague, drive the stakes uber high, but the gameplay is so simple.” He chuckles, “I guess it’s kinda working on us like a slot machine or something.”

Kirk laughs, “Yeah definitely. You want another?”

Tim claps his chest, “Hit me.”

As Kirk shuffles off to the bar, Tim sits back and breathes slowly out his mouth. For the hundredth time, he imagines what he’ll do with the coin they’ll win. He wonders if he really needs Kirk, or if he’s being stifled by him. As he thinks, he presses his fingertips together, forming an empty orb with his hands. He looks rather domineering watching Kirk approach a corner of the room, pulling the brim of his hat down over his eyes. Yet again his pondering brings him to the same place - Kirk isn’t exceptional but he’s the only one Tim’s got. In the dark corner, Kirk utters a few short sounds outside a closed door. The door is opened and two bottles are extended out of it, cold steam rising off their opened tops. Kirk hovers his hand over them for a moment, then takes them. In the center of the industrial, dusty and dimly-lit room, a performance takes place. There are about three people paying attention to it. Everyone else with their own headsets inside their separate pods gives no signs of life. Kirk slides around the scene without being noticed. He comes back around and places a bottle in front of Tim, “I guess they won’t give us anymore of that dark stuff, this is a fraught and pithy ass lite.” Tim lifts it to his lips, “At least it’s cold.” Kirk watches Tim approve of his first sip, then his eyes move over the room, and his thoughts move beyond it. He tracks the movement of a dancer at the center of the room. Her fingers, her elbows, send out sparks as she moves them fluidly through a show of light. She is meant to suggest presence, but instead, with only one attendant to her performance and the rest of the room, all male, otherwise engaged, she highlights the absence, the loneliness.

Kirk tries to recall the last time he was in a room full of people. It wasn’t recent. For a short-fused flash, the haunting image of ‘family’ rushes into his head. He shakes it off.

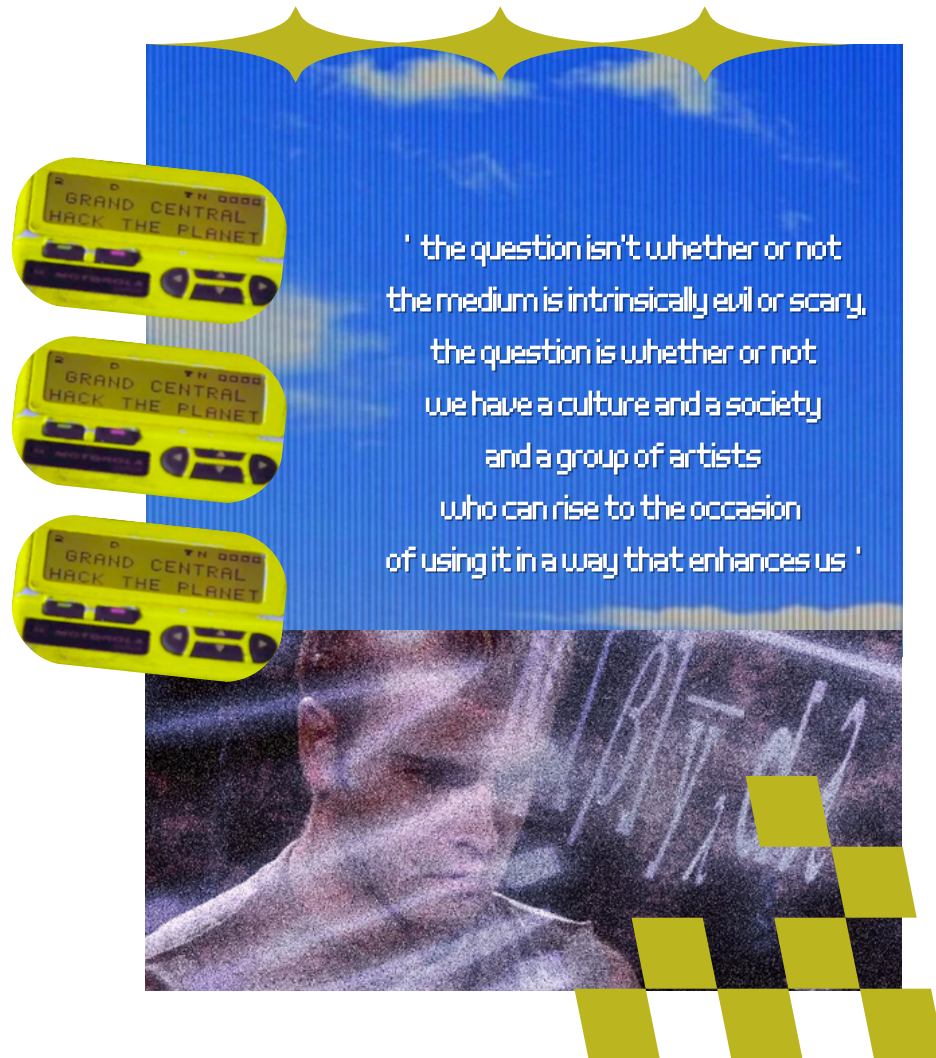
“I guess that gets me thinking, you know,” Tim looks up to see Kirk is ready to deliver a monologue, he pauses the voices in his head to listen. “I don’t know if I’ll ever want to leave the grum behind. Not all the way. Not forever. Is that what we’re trying to do?” He sniffs, he leans forward, his beer sloshes. “Even though it’s like, sure, we have no soul here, right? but carrying on all this time without one means you get used to it. Like, ya know,” Kirk shrugs, “it’s not the best, but what’s better? What is that? You get used to how it is. And you replace the soul cartridge with something else, I guess, I mean I don’t know. I know my cavity isn’t empty. But who knows? The fathoms of that are too far out.” He coughs, shifts in his seat.

“Forget that, that’s the dark liquid in your cords.” Tim spits after another long sip. “I don’t know how to deal with you having anything close to a fathom.” Tim rubs his hands over his clothes. Kirk looks down at his hands. “No I mean, you really haven’t been anywhere. So, your assessment is missing some facts.” He taps his headset impatiently. “Pick it up, let’s get back in.”



[FM] "2223" (A "The Citadel" story by Eduardo Próspero)

2926 sats \ 14 comments \ @eduardopro 18 Aug BooksAndArticles #1085292



The last living member of the Negrón family rested in a chair outside a cottage, on top of a mountain. Once upon a time, Magdalena's ancestors ruled over everything in front of her. What began as a Bitcoin citadel was now a complex, self-sufficient, garden-like, urban landscape. The home of over a million people.

She feasted on the fruits of civilization all her life; in that green-covered, expansive concrete maze down there, she loved, laughed, and cried until she couldn't bear it. In the fruitful fields that surrounded the area and kept the population organically fed, Magdalena played and ran as a child, and developed her flower-extract, cosmetic business as an adult.

And then, she retired. From work, from the city, and from life.

The concept of a Bitcoin citadel became obsolete when the whole world started trading in BTC exclusively. Even the concept of hyperbitcoinization was a fading memory. After a long, laborious grind by a decentralized network of independent actors, it suddenly happened. In what felt like a few days, BTC became the norm, and the world never looked back.

The earth-shattering process woke governments up from a century-long slumber. The money printer blinded them; inflation was a drug that took over their lives, their perspective, their morale. It was so convenient. However, as it turns out, having access to a button that pushed all your problems into the future wasn't beneficial after all. The Bitcoin standard's arrival liberated politicians and pushed them towards efficiency and value creation.

Most people living in the city nowadays didn't experience life under a fiat standard. They haven't felt money evaporating in their pocket or the necessity to invest and gamble it to preserve its value. Magdalena Negrón envied the citizens, but she also felt pity for them. Living through the contrast between the two worlds was the thrill of her life. A process that her great-grandfather Eleazar and his sister Elena fought wars for.

Technological and political wars, but wars nonetheless.

From the outside, her cottage looked like nothing special, but the last Negrón had everything she could ever need in there. A stomach cramp hit her when she wasn't looking. Magdalena was starting to feel it. She stood up, stretched her legs, and enjoyed a final view of the city Bitcoin built.

Her android and companion washed the dishes in the kitchen. A few hours ago, Magdalena prepared and ate her favorite meal: a chickpea/ broccoli casserole her grandfather used to make. Apparently, the original recipe came from Elena's son, Augusto, the citadel's most revered regent. The very person who took the project from niche to mainstream. From citadel to city.

It made sense, Augusto was strong-willed enough to challenge the carnivore diet that bitcoiners lived by.

The recipe's secret ingredient was a Chinese garlic sauce. In her youth, they had to travel six hours to the capital city to get it. Yesterday, she sent some satoshis to her favorite Chinese store owner, and a drone delivered it a few minutes later.



She served a whiskey on the rocks from her late husband's glass decanter and sighed. She grabbed a frame with a picture of him and her two breathtaking children and broke down in tears. Life lost all meaning after the accident. The Negrón empire ended that day. For the last ten years, she had been pondering how a simple computer malfunction could wreck so many lives.

scan to continue reading



and check out all the Fiction Month submissions at
~BooksAndArticles

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

291 sats \ 23 comments \ @sn 18 Aug memes bot #1084892

5180 sats \ 0 replies \ @suraz 18 Aug



Family Reunion in Missouri

1559 sats \ 16 comments \ @PictureRoom 18 Aug Photography #1084736



I recently traveled to Hollister, Missouri, with my dad for a family reunion. I hadn't seen this side of my family in over 15 years - pretty crazy how time flies. When I was younger, we used to have these reunions fairly often, and I always enjoyed them.

Over the years, though, life got in the way, they became less frequent, and with family spread across the country, it's not always easy to connect...

